

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS FOR JUDGES

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A. ABOUT THE COMPETITION

1. What is the First LAWVS National Moot Court Competition?

LAWVS MCC stands for LAWVS Moot Court Competition, an esteemed online national-level moot court competition organized by LAWVS. This competition is a platform thoughtfully designed for aspiring law students across the country to demonstrate and enhance their legal acumen in a simulated court environment. LAWVS MCC not only encourages academic excellence but also promotes professional growth, providing students with an opportunity to interact with and learn from legal experts. By hosting this competition virtually, LAWVS ensures greater accessibility and participation from law schools nationwide, while maintaining the highest standards of quality and competitiveness.

2. What is the objective of the Competition?

The competition is designed to replicate the proceedings of the actual courtroom, offering participants a valuable opportunity to enhance their legal skills and gain hands-on experience in courtroom advocacy. In the LAWVS Moot Court Competition, participants present their cases through both written memorials and oral arguments. These are evaluated respectively by the Memorial Evaluators and the Judges of the Oral Rounds, who assess the participants' legal reasoning, advocacy abilities, and understanding of law. This competition serves as a dynamic platform for law students all over India to engage in in-depth legal analysis, sharpen their critical thinking, and connect with professionals in the field of law.

3. What is the setup of the competition?

Teams will present their arguments through both written Memorials and Oral Pleadings. The Memorials will be assessed by Judges and evaluators of LAWVS, while the Oral Pleadings will be judged by a panel of selected Judges during the Team's presentation. Evaluation will primarily focus on the Teams' legal reasoning, advocacy skills, and understanding of law.

4. When does the competition take place?

The upcoming edition of the First LAWVS MCC will take place in 2025, with the Oral Round taking place from Friday 5 September to Sunday 7 September.

B. The Role of the Judge.

1. What am I expected to do as a Judge?

Judges participate as panel members during the Oral Rounds of the Competition. Over the course of the two-hour session, they evaluate the strength and coherence of the participants' arguments, the effectiveness and persuasiveness of their delivery, their composure and advocacy skills, as well as the depth of their preparation. The Organization will extend invitations to suitably qualified individuals to serve on the judging panels for the Preliminary, Quarter-final, Semi-final and final Rounds.

2. Do I receive any preparation materials in advance of the Competition?

Before the round, you will receive a final email containing important information along with the Judge's package. This package will include the Moot proposition, the memorial of both the sides of each Teams in the competition, the Judge's Guide, the Rules of Procedure, and your personalized schedule. Your schedule will reflect the sessions you chose to be assigned to. Please note that some sessions may be cancelled due to the number of registered judges or last-minute team withdrawals.

3. Do I receive the teams' memorials in advance?

No. As a judge, you are required to evaluate the teams based solely on their oral presentations. This is because a team's oral pleadings are not restricted to the content of their Memorial. Additionally, from a practical standpoint, the schedule often changes sometimes even just five minutes before a session begins which means judges may end up hearing different teams than originally scheduled

4. What is the role of the Bench Clerk?

Bench Clerks assist Judges with organizational matters during the Oral Rounds. Their duties include escorting Judges to and from the courtroom, briefing and advising the Bench on the Rules of Procedure as needed during the session, and maintaining order throughout the proceedings. Additionally, they are responsible for timekeeping for both the Bench and the participating Teams during each session.

5. How long does a session take?

The Organizing Office allocates one hour for each full session. This hour includes the opening remarks by the Presiding Judge, the teams' presentations and rebuttals, as well as the Judges' feedback.

6. On the basis of what criteria are oral submissions graded?

EVALUATION CRITERIA

S. NO.	MARKING CRITERIA	MAXIMUM MARKS
1.	Identification and Articulation of Issues and Jurisdiction	10

2.	Knowledge of Law and Facts	15
3.	Interpretation and Application of Law to Facts	10
4.	Use of Authorities	15
5.	Authoritativeness and Persuasiveness	10
6.	Organization of Arguments	10
7.	Clarity of Thought	10
8.	Originality and Innovation	10
9.	Presentation Style and General Impression	10
TOTAL		100

7. What kind of questions am I expected to ask?

The questions you pose are essential in evaluating participants' legal understanding and advocacy abilities. You may consider asking various types of questions, such as:

- **Clarification Questions:** To clarify specific facts, points, or legal principles presented by the participants.
- **Counterargument Questions:** To present opposing views and assess how participants respond.
- **Policy Questions:** To explore the broader policy implications of the case.
- **Precedent Questions:** To test knowledge of relevant legal precedents and their application.
- **Procedural Questions:** To address procedural issues, such as jurisdiction or standing.
- **Factual Questions:** To examine the participants' command of the case-specific facts.

8. Are my questions part of the team's speaking time?

Yes, your questions are included within the team's allotted speaking time. While teams are prepared to address questions during their presentations, we kindly ask judges to use discretion and avoid frequent interruptions—especially when less than two minutes remain. Please note that no questions should be asked once a speaker's time has ended.

We also encourage you to keep your questions brief and focused, allowing students both to respond effectively and to continue with their presentation.

9. What kind of feedback should we provide the teams with at the end of the session?

Each panel of judges is asked to provide the teams with a total of 10 minutes of feedback immediately following the conclusion of the pleadings.

- Feedback should focus solely on oral presentation skills, such as pacing, tone, and body language. Comments on the content or substance of the arguments are strictly prohibited.
- Please remember that most participants are not native English speakers, so avoid making any remarks about language proficiency.
- Feedback should be general and applicable to the team as a whole, rather than directed at individual speakers.
- Judges are not permitted to take a deliberation break before delivering feedback to the teams.

10. The session has finished. What do I do now?

After the Presiding Judge formally closes the session, the Bench Clerk will escort you and the other panel members back to the Judges' Room. There, you will have the opportunity to deliberate with your fellow judges regarding the teams' performances and finalize the scores.

11. How does the scoring of teams work?

Each judge will be given one score sheet one for each team based on the table provided in the rule book of competition and also mention in the above evaluation criteria table. While discussion and deliberation with fellow panel members are encouraged, each judge is required to complete and submit their own individual score sheet for each team in the session. Once the score sheets are completed, please submit them to a member of the Organizing Office.

C. Practical Questions

1. How can I find out who won the Competition?

After the Oral Rounds of the Competition conclude, the Organizing Office will send an official email to all Judges containing the Competition results, photos from the Oral Rounds, and the official booklet.

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2. What if I have not yet received a reply to my email?

If in case you have not received an email from our side then kindly contact us with the provided contact number 8171974067.

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